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Curriculum Vitae

Professional Experience

Head of Department, Department of Economics, Central European University, 2026 – .
Associate Professor (with tenure), Department of Economics, Central European University, 2018 – .
Economist. WIFO Institute, 2024 – 2026.
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Central European University, 2011 – 2018.
Visiting Scholar, Department of Economics, Harvard University, Sep–Dec 2017.

Research interests

Applied Microeconomics, Industrial Organization, Economics of Education.

My research interests span a broad range of topics in structural microeconometrics. Most recently, I have been working on college admission mechanisms and spatial location of firms.

Education

Ph.D., Economics, The Pennsylvania State University, 2011
Dissertation title: "Essays in Applied Microeconomics"

M.A., Economics, New Economic School, Russia, 2005
M.Sc., Mathematics, Moscow State University, Russia, 2003

Working Papers

Akyol, Pelin, Krishna, Kala, and Sergey Lychagin. 2026. "Targeting the Gender Placement Gap: Marks versus Money." NBER Working Paper 33074.
McLean, Lewis, Krishna, Kala, and Sergey Lychagin. 2026. "Injury, Workload, and the Strategic Response of Coaches in the NBA." NBER Working Paper 35803.

Academic Publications

Krishna, Kala, Lychagin, Sergey, Olszewski, Wojciech, Siegel, Ron, and Chloe Tergiman. 2026. "Pareto Improvements in the Contest for College Admissions." *Review of Economic Studies*, 93(1): 629–663.
Frisancho, Veronica, Krishna, Kala, and Sergey Lychagin. 2018. "Retaking in High Stakes Exams: Is Less More?" *International Economic Review*, 52(2): 449–477.
Lychagin, Sergey. 2016. "Spillovers, Absorptive Capacity and Agglomeration." *Journal of Urban Economics*, 96: 17–35.
Frisancho, Veronica, Krishna, Kala, Lychagin, Sergey, and Cemile Yavas. 2016. "Better Luck Next Time: Learning Through Retaking," *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, 125: 120–135.

Lychagin, Sergey, Pinkse, Joris, Slade, Margaret, and John VanReenen. 2016. "Spillovers in Space: Does Geography Matter?" *Journal of Industrial Economics*, 64(2): 295–335.

Das, Sanghamitra, Krishna, Kala, Lychagin, Sergey and Rohini Somanathan. 2013. "Back on the Rails: Competition and Productivity in State-Owned Industry," *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 5(1): 136–162.

Policy Articles

Tergiman, Chloe, Siegel, Ron, Lychagin, Sergey, Olszewski, Wojciech and Kala Krishna. "Reducing college admissions stress," VoxEU.org, 31 August 2022.

Das, Sanghamitra, Krishna, Kala, Lychagin, Sergey and Rohini Somanathan. "Inefficient Public-Sector Undertakings: Is Competition a Remedy?" VoxEU.org, 30 May 2011.

Lychagin, Sergey, Pinkse, Joris, Slade, Margaret, and John VanReenen. "You Can Raise Productivity Through R&D, But Geography Matters a Lot," VoxEU.org, 25 October 2010.

Teaching Experience

Principles of Microeconomics (BA), 2020–
Empirical Research Seminar (PhD), 2020–2021
Intermediate Econometrics (BA), 2022–
Designing Markets That Work (MA), 2021, 2025
Econometrics (MA), 2012–2023
Industrial Organization (MA & PhD), 2011–2026
Economic Geography (MA & PhD), 2012
PhD Research Seminar, 2013–2017

Awards

Bates White Fellowship, 2008 – 2009
Graduate Scholar Award, Pennsylvania State University, 2005

Seminar and Conference Talks

2024: WIFO (Vienna)
2023: University of Vienna
2022: Higher School of Economics, Workshop on Gender and Education (Collegio Carlo Alberto).
2021: Pennsylvania State University.
2016: Economics in Education Conference (Penn State), IAAE Annual Conference, EEA-ESEM Geneva.
2015: Lisbon Workshop on Economics, Statistics and Econometrics of Education, University of Alicante, SOLE/EALE meeting in Montreal
2014: University of Cardiff, University of Exeter, Pompeu Fabra University
2013: University of St. Gallen
2012: Workshop on the Economics of ICTs, Royal Economic Society Conference, Delhi School of Economics, Annual GDN Conference, New Economic School 20th Anniversary Conference
2011: Ifo Institute EGIT Meeting, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Central European University, McMaster University, Ryerson University, Penn State University

Referee Activity

Review of Economic Studies, AEJ Applied Economics, Journal of Political Economy, International Economic Review, Quantitative Economics, Journal of

European Economic Association, Journal of International Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Regional Studies, Canadian Journal of Economics, European Economic Review, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Education Finance and Policy, Hungarian Statistical Review, Information Economics and Policy, Annals of Regional Science, Journal of Asian and African Studies, Journal of Regional Science, Review of International Economics, Technovation, Industrial and Corporate Change.

Other Service

Organizer of the Student Conference in Economics (2022-2023)
Program Director of MA in Economics (2022-2023)
Program Director of Data Science and Society undergraduate program (2023–2026)